

Robot hardware

ROS 2 interface

RVT-Swarm onboard controller

Swarm network

Robot output

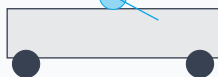
2D LiDAR
range rays $\mathcal{L}_i^t = \{\rho_i^m\}_{m=1}^M$

Wheel encoders + IMU
fused by base/localization stack
 $s_i^t = (p_i, v_i, \psi_i)$

Onboard computer
ROS 2 Jazzy runtime
RVT checkpoint: rvt_swarm.pt

Wi-Fi / DDS network
exchanges peer state
within radius R_c

Differential-drive base
low-level motor controller
wheels (ω_L, ω_R)



Robot drivers or Gazebo bridge
real robot: LiDAR/base drivers
simulation: ros_gz_bridge

Topic contract per robot tb3.i
/scan: sensor_msgs/LaserScan
/odom: nav_msgs/Odometry
/cmd_vel: geometry_msgs/Twist

State cache in rvt_agent
odom callback $\rightarrow s_i^t = (p_i, v_i, \psi_i)$
scan callback $\rightarrow \mathcal{L}_i^t$

Sensor-to-policy adapter
LiDAR clustering: $\mathcal{O}_i^t = \{o_k, \dot{o}_k\}$
active team: $\mathcal{A}_i^t = \{i\} \cup \mathcal{N}_i^t$
observation: $\Omega_i^t = (s, \mathcal{L}, \mathcal{O}, g, z, s_{\text{form}})$

one rvt_agent node runs on each robot

Build local interaction graph
 $G_i^t = (V_i^t, E_i^t)$ from active teammates
node $x_j \in \mathbb{R}^{68}$, edge $e_{jk} \in \mathbb{R}^{11}$

RVT graph policy inference
 $h_j = \text{GNN}(x_j, e_{jk})$
outputs: action bank a_j^k , topology logits
 ℓ_k , recoverability q_k , uncertainty σ_k

Topology selector
 $\tilde{q}_k = q_k - \lambda \sigma_k$
 $H_k = H(\ell_k, \tilde{q}_k, k_{t-1})$
 $k_t = \arg \max_k H_k$

Topology runtime
 $z_t, s_t, \text{subteam}_i$
 $= F_{\text{topo}}(k_t, b_t)$
 $z_t, \hat{e}_t$

CBF-QP shield
trigger: $r_{\text{col}} \geq \theta$
 $a_i^{k_t} \mapsto \tilde{a}_i$

Projection to robot command
desired velocity: $v_i^d = v_i + \tilde{a}_i \Delta t$
differential-drive projection:
 $u_i = (v_x, \omega_z) = \Pi_{\text{TB3}}(v_i^d, \psi_i)$

u_i

Peer-state publisher
sends $m_i^t = (p_i, v_i, \psi_i, z_t, s_t, \text{subteam}_i)$
topic: /swarm/peer_states

Peer-state subscriber
receives m_j^t from nearby robots
filters by timeout and communication radius

Mission command
goal topic: /swarm/goal
shared target $g = (g_x, g_y)$

Deployment idea. The RVT controller does not require direct motor access. It only needs standard ROS 2 sensor topics and publishes standard cmd_vel. On a real UGV, replace Gazebo bridge with hardware drivers and keep the same topic contract.

Velocity command
/tb3.i/cmd_vel
 $u_i = (v_x, \omega_z)$

Base controller
converts body command to wheel commands
 $(v_x, \omega_z) \rightarrow (\omega_L, \omega_R)$

Robot motion in world
updates $p_i^{t+1}, v_i^{t+1}, \psi_i^{t+1}$
closes the sensor-control loop

Run outputs for paper/evaluation
trajectories $\mathcal{T} = \{p_i^t\}$
FormOK, collision-free, success, topology switches

next sensors